Reuters: IBM's higher software revenue growth floor leaves a durability test

SINGLE-SOURCE REPORT - REUTERS: IBM's reported software revenue growth range has a higher floor and unchanged ceiling. Demand after delayed deals clear remains the test.

Chờ đọc duyệt · Does the reported higher software outlook establish durable demand after delayed deals clear?



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IBM headquarters in Armonk. Archive context image; Commons DateTimeOriginal records 2010-08-03. · Mark Hillary / Wikimedia Commons / Creative Commons Attribution 2.0 · License · Image source

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SINGLE-SOURCE REPORT - REUTERS: IBM's reported software outlook lifts the growth floor while keeping the ceiling unchanged. Reuters' October 21, 2026 account of Kavanaugh's comments puts annual software revenue growth at about 7% to 8%, compared with 6% to 8% previously. If accurate, that revision would narrow the weaker end of management's range without establishing lasting demand after delayed deals clear. Reuters

Reuters puts third-quarter company-wide revenue at $17.10 billion, with reported growth of 4.7%, against a $16.82 billion average analyst estimate compiled by LSEG. Its separate software figures are $7.80 billion in quarterly revenue, growth of 8.3% and a $7.62 billion estimate. Reuters

The transaction-processing denominator matters

Reuters attributes a narrower revenue split to Kavanaugh: about 25% of transaction-processing revenue came from business deferred from the second quarter, while he characterized the other 75% as net new business. Those shares describe transaction-processing revenue; they cannot be applied to all IBM revenue or treated as a breakdown of software revenue growth. Reuters

If Reuters' account is accurate, delayed deals reaching the current quarter could strengthen reported revenue without establishing a lasting increase in fresh demand. Capital Chronicle's timing test is whether new business can sustain growth once that catch-up fades. Reuters

If Kavanaugh's transaction-processing breakdown reported by Reuters is accurate, the new-business component would challenge a catch-up-only explanation. Fresh business and delayed deals could coexist. Reuters

Recurrence needs comparable evidence

Comparable disclosures of new and deferred transaction-processing business would test recurrence. Continued software growth supported by margins and cash conversion would strengthen the durable-demand reading; weaker follow-through would challenge it. Reuters

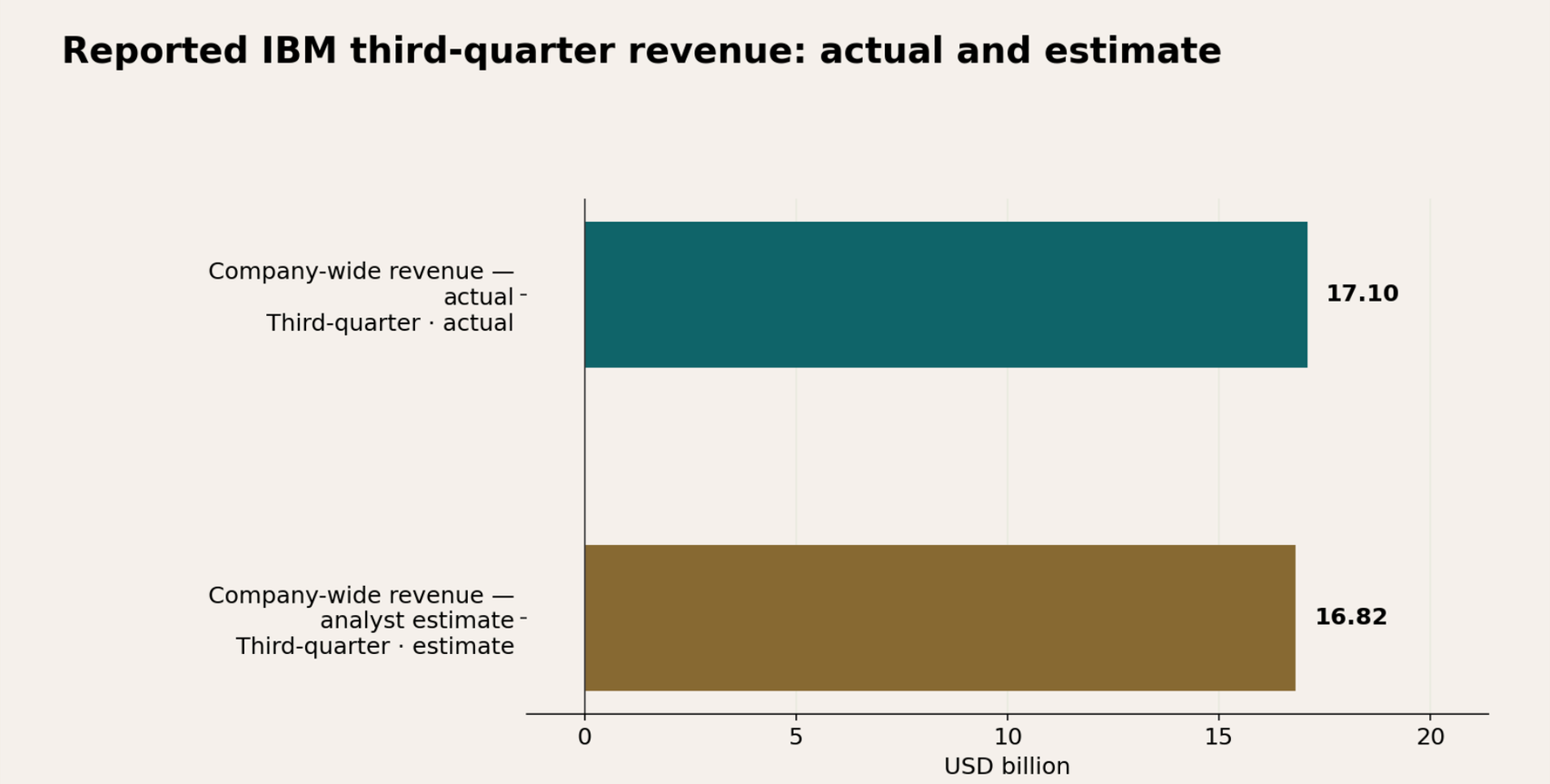
Source notes: The Reuters report is dated October 21, 2026, at 20:12 UTC. This editorial revision retains the facts and source date of the earlier unpublished analysis; it adds no new reporting or independent confirmation. The figures and Kavanaugh's comments remain attributed through Reuters. Reuters

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Reported IBM third-quarter revenue: actual and estimate Source: Reuters; retained report 2026-10-21. · Image source

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NEWSROOM BRIEF

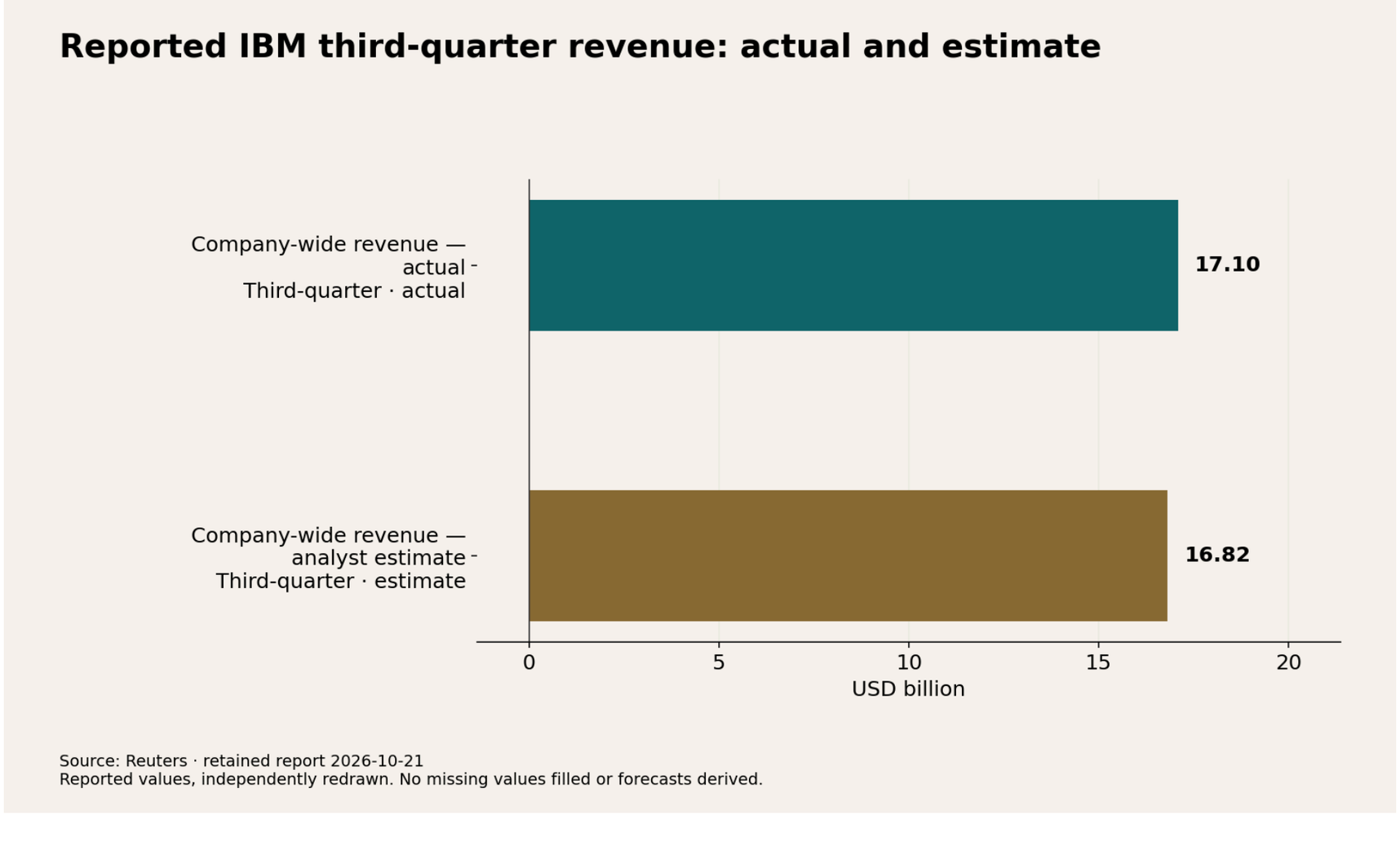
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Reuters reports a higher IBM software growth floor with the same ceiling.

What to watch: Comparable disclosures of new and deferred transaction-processing business would test recurrence.

Full brief: [Canonical link pending]

Source date: 2026-10-21. Interpretation remains analysis.



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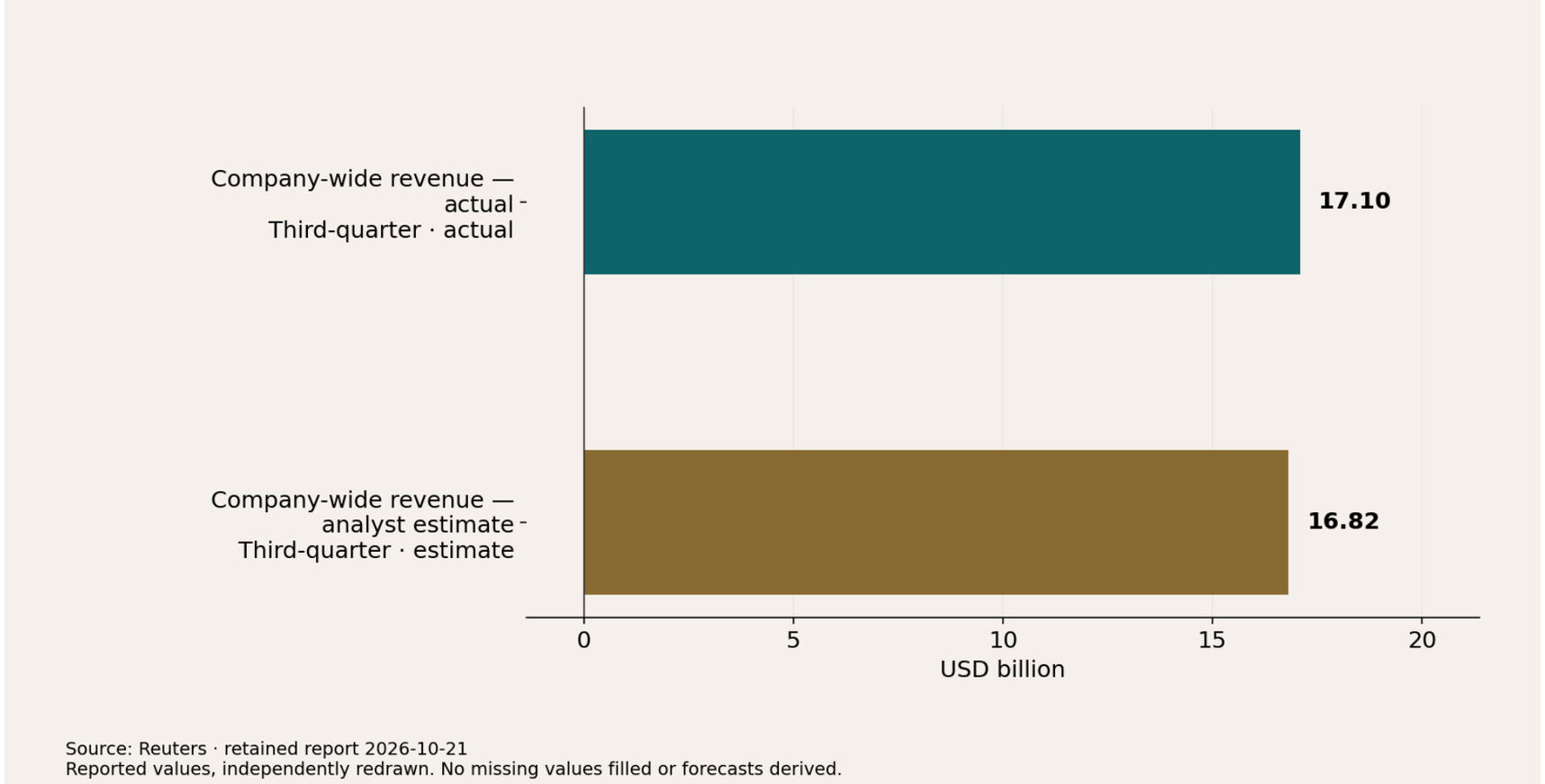
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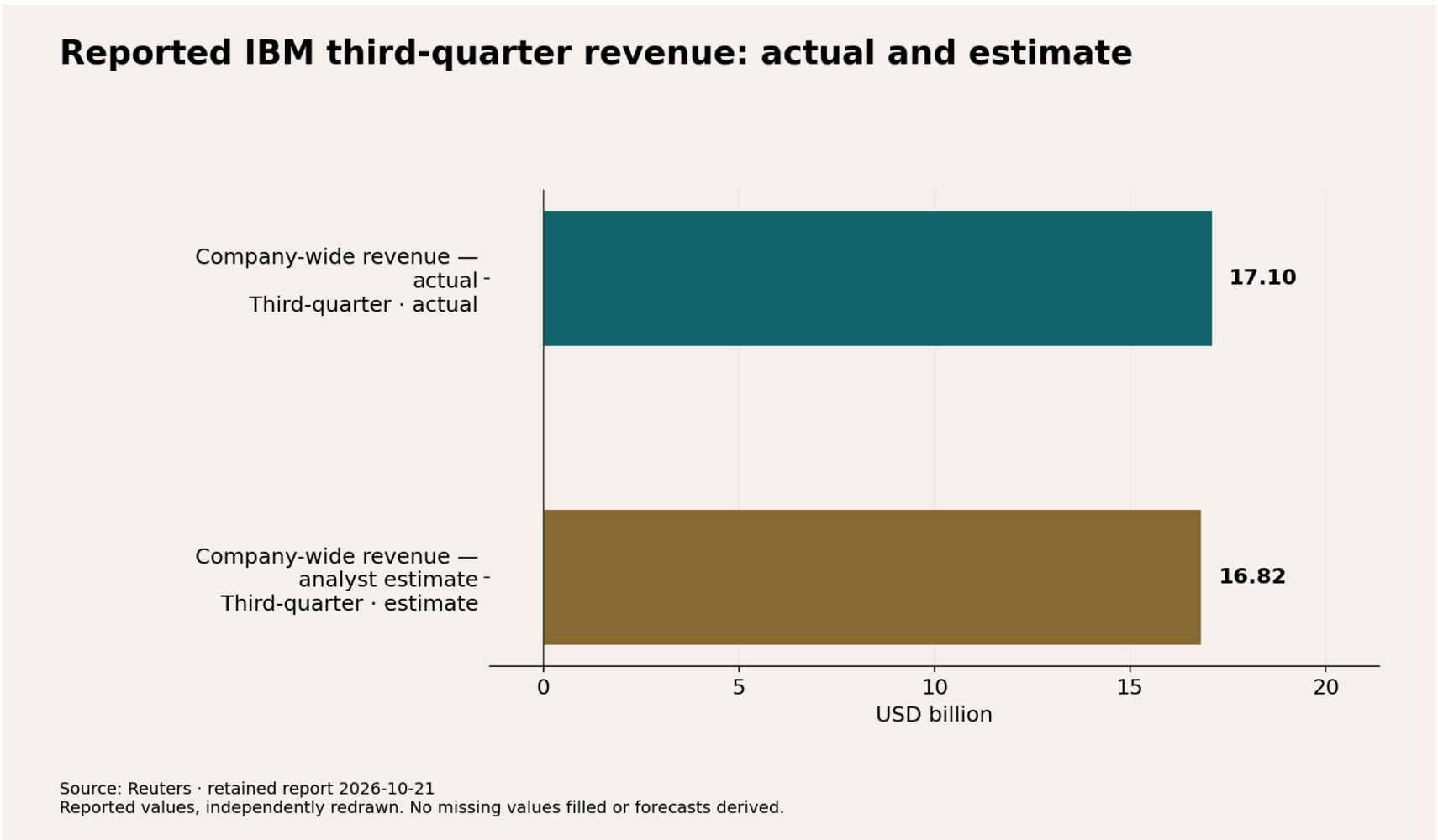
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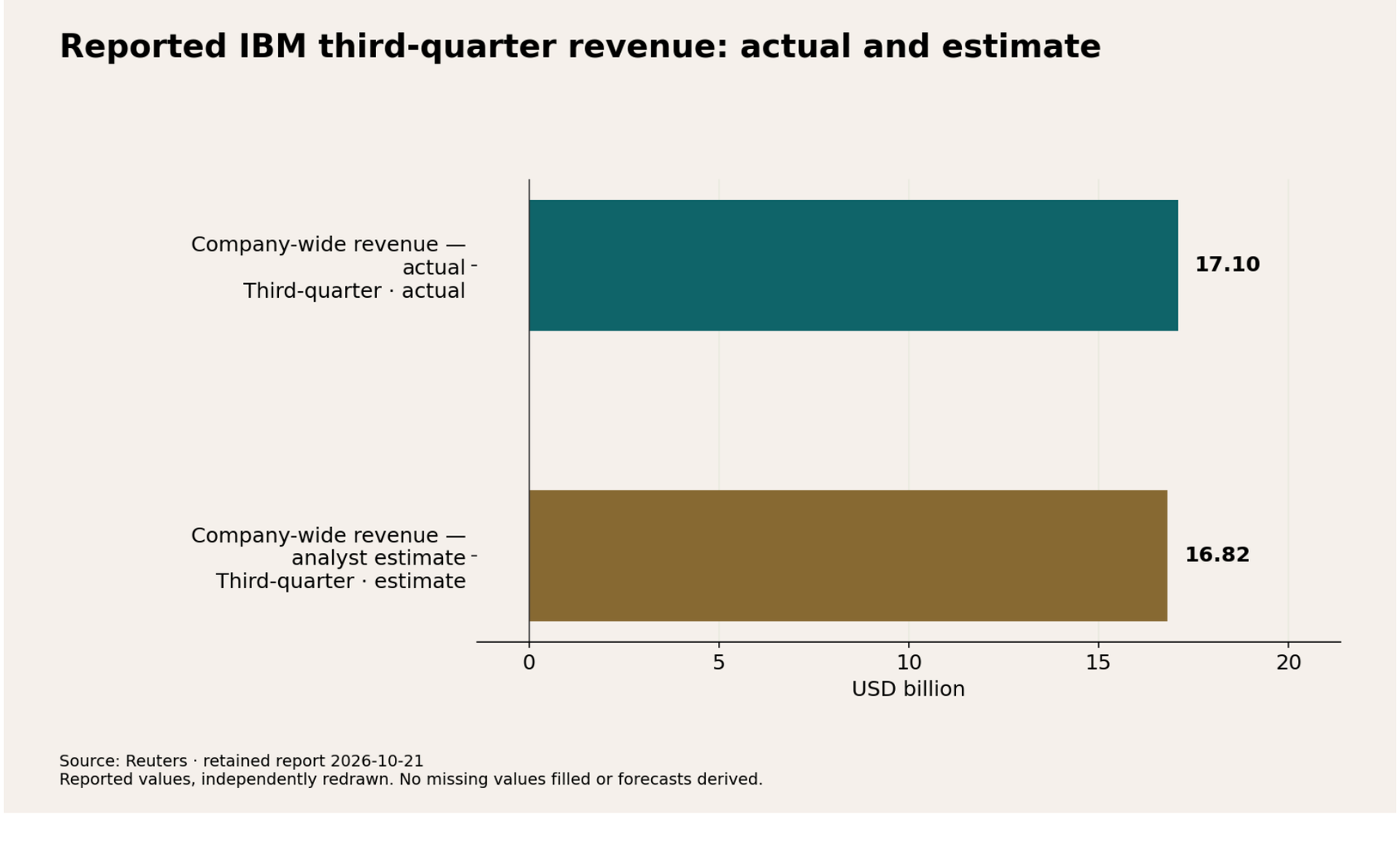
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Reported IBM third-quarter revenue: actual and estimate

Company-wide revenue — actual
Third-quarter · actual
17.10
Company-wide revenue — analyst estimate
Third-quarter · estimate
16.82
0
5
10
15
20
USD billion
Source: Reuters · retained report 2026-10-21
Reported values, independently redrawn. No missing values filled or forecasts derived.

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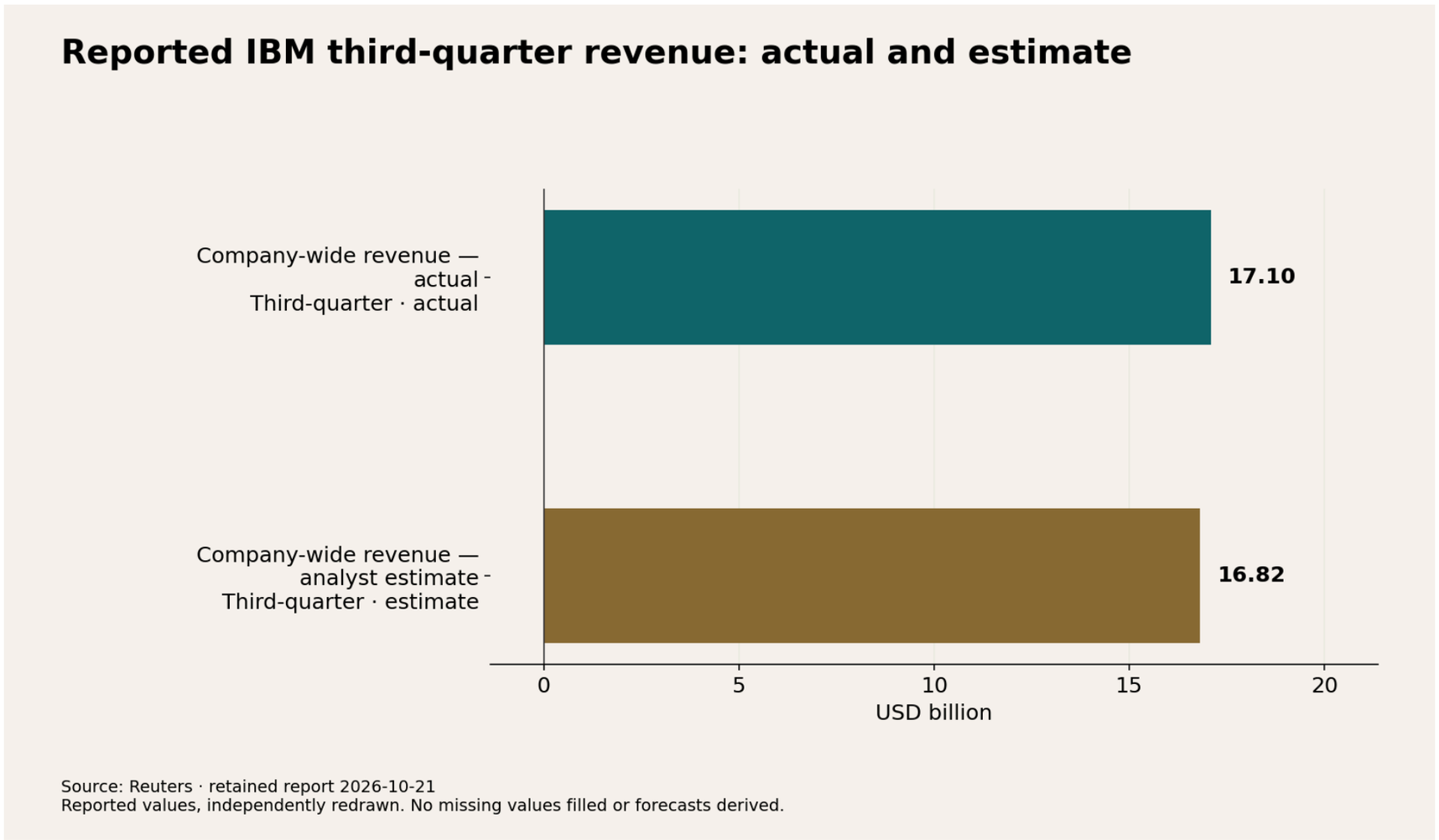
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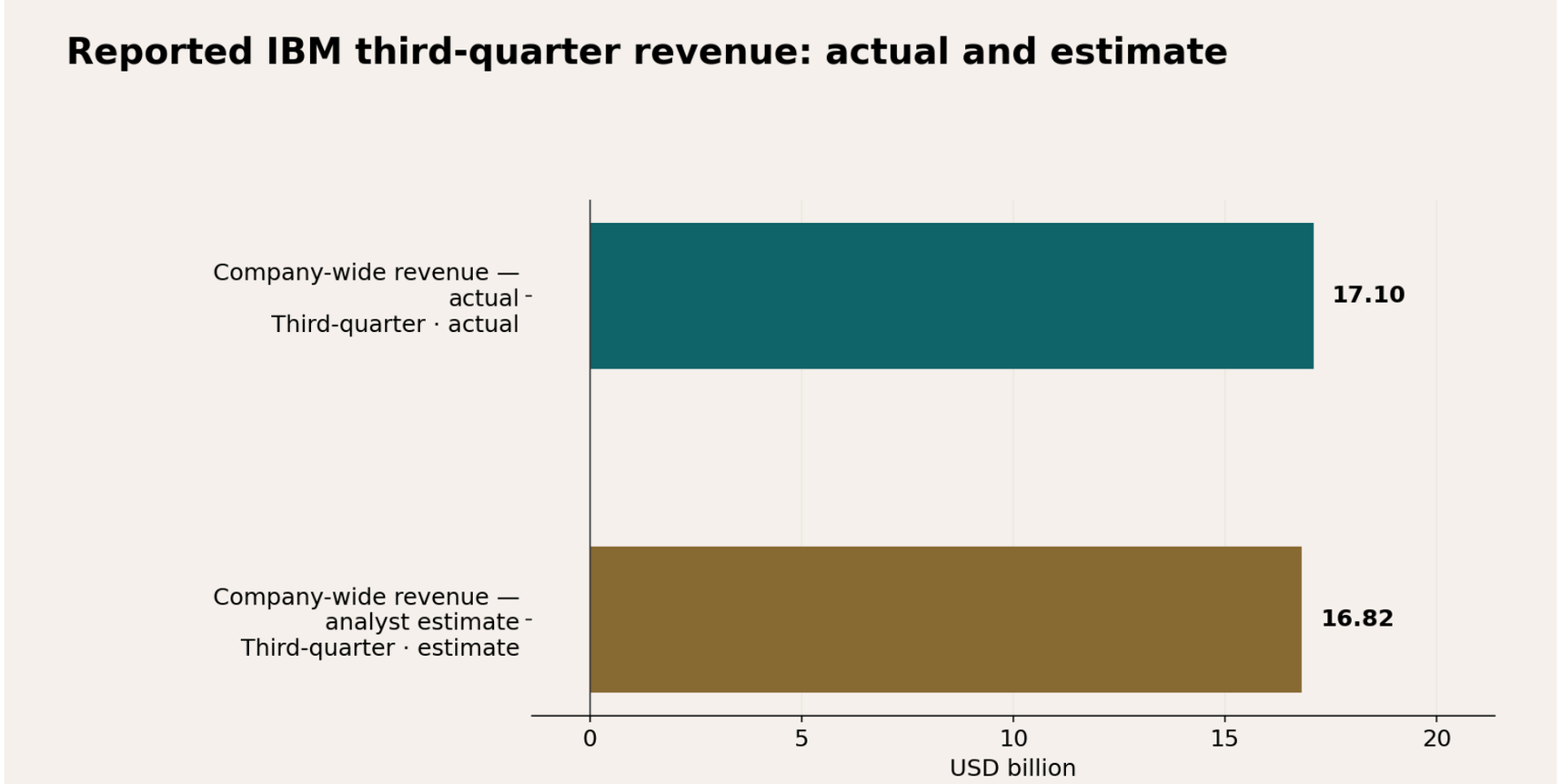
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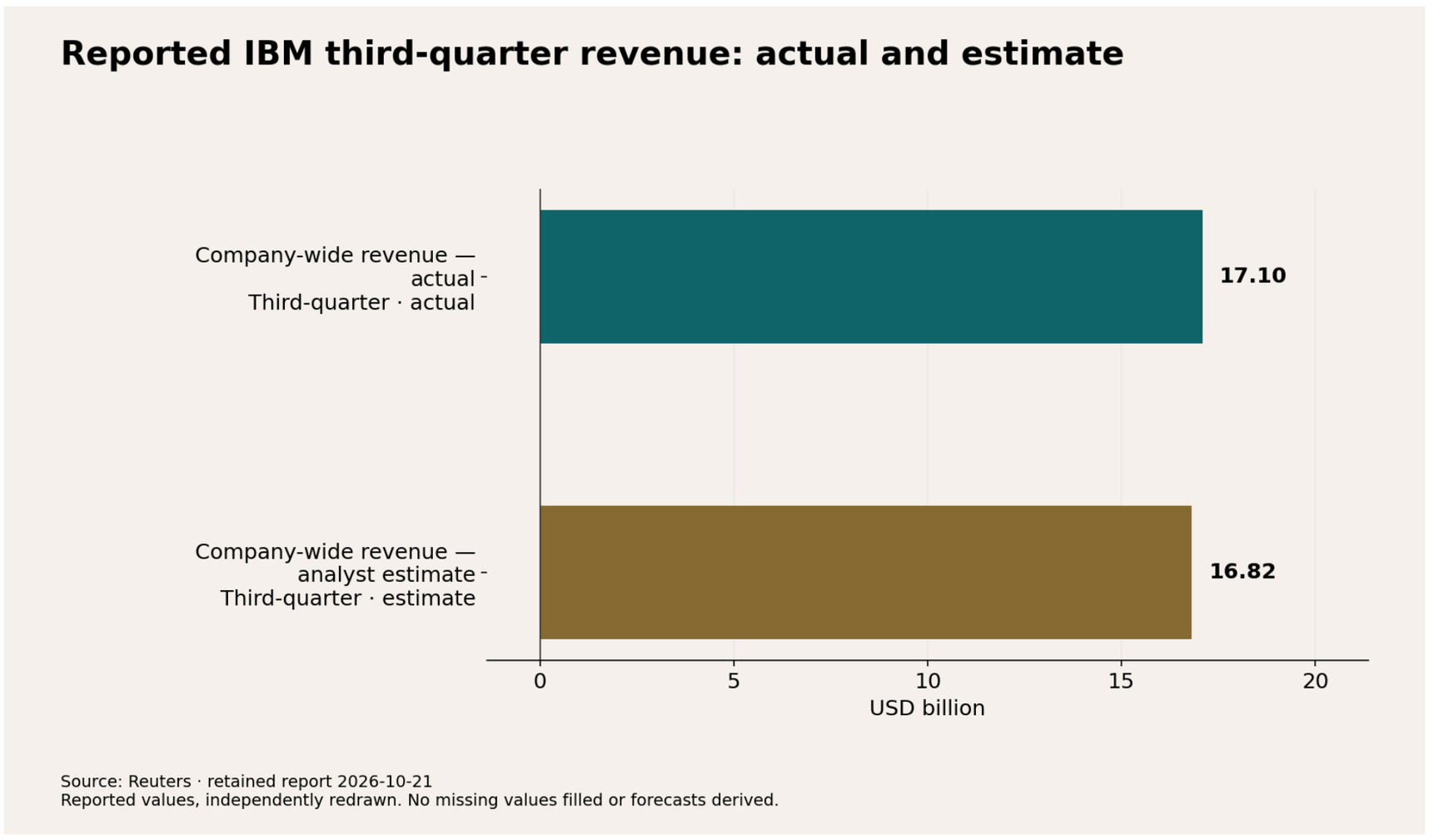
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